

Chapter-10

Determiners

Definition: A determiner is a word which announces the coming of a noun in a sentence. It is used before a noun to qualify or modify it. Most of adjectives function as determiners because they are used before nouns to describe them. An adjective used after a noun is not considered to be a determiner.

Kinds of Determiners

Kinds of Determiners	Examples
1. Articles	a, an, the
2. Adjectives of Number (Indefinite, Cardinals, Ordinals)	one, two, tenth, some, many, more, most few, a few, the few, fewer, several, all, both, any etc.
3. Adjectives of Quantity	some, much, more, most, little, a little, the little, less, whole, half, no, any etc.
4. Possessive Adjectives	my, our, his, her, your, their, its
5. Demonstrative Adjectives	this, that, these, those, such
6. Interrogative Adjectives	what, which, whose
7. Distributive Adjectives	each, every, either, neither

Articles

Read the following sentences carefully.

1. I have **an** imported pen.
2. **The** pen has **a** golden cap.
3. **The** cap has **a** pin.
4. **The** pin has **an** automatic button.

In the above sentences, the words 'a', 'an' and 'the' are called **articles**.

There are two types of articles:

1. **Indefinite Articles:** 'A' and 'an' are called indefinite articles.
2. **Definite Article:** 'The' is called definite article.

Use of 'A' and 'An'

Both 'a' and 'an' are used to denote a countable singular noun. 'A' is used before a noun which starts with a consonant sound whereas 'an' is used before a noun which starts with a vowel sound.

Vowel and Consonant Sounds

There are 26 letters in English alphabet. Generally, out of 26 letters 'a', 'e', 'i', 'o' and 'u' are considered to be vowels and the remaining 21 letters are considered to be consonants. In fact, these 26 letters used individually or in combinations, produce 44 sounds. Thus, there are 44 sounds in English language. Out of these 44 sounds, there are 20 vowel sounds and 24 consonant sounds. 'A', 'e', 'i', 'o' and 'u' are letters frequently used to start a word with a vowel sound, hence, often labelled as vowels. While selecting the article 'a' or 'an' for a singular noun, it is important to note whether the noun starts with a vowel sound or a consonant sound. It is not the first letter which decides the sound; it is the pronunciation of the word that decides the sound.

Read the table given below to understand the concept of vowel and consonant sounds.

The nouns that start with letters 'a', 'e', 'i', 'o', 'u' and start with a vowel sound	The nouns that start with letters 'a', 'e', 'i', 'o', 'u', but start with a consonant sound	The nouns that don't start with letters 'a', 'e', 'i', 'o', 'u' but start with a vowel sound
apple, axe, ant, aunt	union	SDO, SSP, SLA
egg, elephant, engine	European, ewe	MLA, MP, MA
inkpot, igloo, ice	useful thing	FO, NGO
ox, orange, onion	university	honest, hour, heir
umbrella, uncle	utopia, one-eyed man	

Important Note: Sometimes a noun is preceded by an adjective or an adverb and an adjective. In such a case the article 'a' or 'an' will be selected according to the first sound of the word that follows the article.

Examples: an egg, a boiled egg, a well boiled egg, a boy, an intelligent boy etc.

Use of 'A/an'

- ◇ To suggest numerical one : **Examples:** 1. Give me a mango. 2. He wants an apple.
- ◇ Before a singular countable noun when it is mentioned for the first time and represents no particular person or thing:
Examples: 1. I met a man on the way. 2. He has an umbrella.
- ◇ In sense of every: **Example:** 1. An apple a day keeps the doctor away.
- ◇ To represent a class: **Examples:** 1. A dog is a useful animal. A pronoun replaces a noun.
- ◇ Before the names of professions and noun complements:
Examples: 1. My father is a teacher. 2. He wants to be a successful person.
- ◇ Before a proper noun used in the sense of a common noun:
Examples: 1. A Daniel (a very wise judge) comes to judgement. 2. He is a Milton. (an inspired poet)
- ◇ Before certain numerical expressions:
Examples: a couple, a dozen, a score, a cross, a million, a hundred, a lot of, a great many, a great deal of
- ◇ In expression of frequency: **Examples:** once a week, thrice a day
- ◇ In expressions of price, speed, ratio, weight etc.
Examples: five rupees a kilogram, seventy miles an hour, hundred rupees a metre.
- ◇ Before few and little: 'A few' means a small number and 'a little' means a small amount.
Examples: 1. A little knowledge is a dangerous thing. 2. There were only a few students in the class.
- ◇ Before 'half': **Examples:** One and a half kilos, or a kilo and a half, a half holiday, a half-share
- ◇ In exclamations, before singular countable nouns:
Examples: 1. What an unfortunate thing! 2. What a charming sight!
- ◇ Before the word 'lie' as a singular noun:
Example: He is telling a lie.
- ◇ To denote certain meanings:
Examples: 1. He has a chance of winning the match. (some)
2. Birds of a feather flock together. (the same)
3. Only a Newton can answer this question. (one like)
- ◇ 'A' can be used before Mr./Mrs./Ms. to refer to an indefinite person, not known personally.
Examples: 1. A Mr. Khosala was in the chair. 2. A Mrs. Jain gave away the prices.

Omission of 'A'/'an'

- ◇ Before plural nouns: **Examples:** boys, apples, children etc.
- ◇ Before uncountable nouns: **Examples:** information, luggage, scenery, furniture etc.
- ◇ Before material nouns such as iron, gold, silver, glass, cloth, wood etc.
However, if any of these nouns refer to a particular thing, it takes an article.
Examples: a gold (incorrect), a bangle of gold (correct) a news (incorrect), a piece of news (incorrect)
Examples: 1. These chairs are made of wood.
2. The wood used in making these chairs is of good quality.
- ◇ Before abstract nouns such as joy, fear, honesty, happiness, grief, sorrow, hope, death etc. However, when used in a particular sense, it may take an article.
Examples: 1. Fear is the greatest enemy of man. 2. Beauty needs no ornaments
3. A fear of snakes overpowered him. 4. Isn't she a beauty?
- ◇ Before a noun used as a complement after the verbs like nominated, appointed, elected, made, declared etc.
Examples: 1. He was elected MLA. (not an MLA) 2. The teacher made him monitor. (not a/the monitor)
- ◇ Before names of meal, except when following an adjective:
Examples: 1. I will meet you after lunch. 2. It was a memorable lunch.
However, the indefinite article is used when a meal is for a special person:
Example: I hosted a dinner in the Director's honour.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with the article 'a' or 'an'.

1.apple.....day keeps the doctor away.
2. I take.....boiled egg every morning.
3. He put.....ice cube in the glass.
4. The king saw.....ant trying to climb up the wall.
5. We sawelephant in the forest.
6. Some workers of the factory have formed.....union.
7. Take umbrella with you; it may rain today.
8. Somesh is.....intelligent boy.
9. This is.....useful book.
10. My sister isMA, B.Ed.
11. I will return from the market in.....hour.
12. The woodcutter hadiron axe.
13. My father isMLA.
14. Mahatma Gandhi wanted to create.....utopia in India.
15. Joseph isEuropean.
16. My sister isuniversity student.
17. He is.....one-eyed man.
18. My mother runsNGO.
19. I boughtnew inkpot from the market.
20. I have.....ram and.....ewe.
21. My ambition in life is to become.....doctor.
22. There isempty bottle on the table.
23. Sixty minutes make.....hour.
24.orange is.....citric fruit.
25.Eskimo lives in.....igloo.

Use of Definite Article : 'The'

Article 'the' is called definite article because it denotes a particular person, place or thing.

Examples: 1. I met a boy. (any boy/ not a particular boy)

2. The boy was wearing a blue shirt. (the boy here means a particular boy referred to in the first sentence.)

3. The shirt was very beautiful. (a particular shirt which is referred to in the second sentence)

4. The girls of this class are more intelligent than the boys. (particular girls and boys)

- ◇ To denote the whole class:
Examples: 1. The dog is a faithful animal. 2. The cow is a useful animal.
- ◇ Before a noun which by reason of locality can represent only one particular thing:
Examples: 1. Mother is in the kitchen. (the kitchen of this house)
2. Has the postman come? (the postman of our area)
- ◇ Before adjectives in the superlative degree:
Example: He is the tallest boy in the class.
- ◇ Before comparatives:
Examples: 1. The higher you go, the cooler it is.
2. He is the taller of the two brothers.
- ◇ Before words indicating number, weight, measure etc.:
Examples: 1. Cloth is sold by the metre. 2. Oranges are sold by the dozen.
- ◇ Before words denoting well-known historical events:
Examples: The French Revolution, the partition of India, the Quit India Movement
- ◇ Before the names of rivers, canals and seas, oceans, group of islands, gulfs, bays, winds, seasons, deserts, plains:
Examples: The Ganges, The Yamuna, the Satluj, the Godavari, the Dead sea, the Pacific Ocean, the Indira Gandhi Canal, the Andaman and Nikobar Islands, the Bay of Bengal, the Persian Gulf, the West Wind, the summer, the Sahara, the Northern Plains etc.
- ◇ Before mountain ranges:
Examples: The Himalayas, the Aravalies, the Shivalik etc.
- ◇ Before certain geographical names:
Examples: the Deccan, the highland, the plains etc.
- ◇ Before the names of certain books and scriptures:
Examples: the Geeta, the Mahabharata, the Vedas, the Koran (Quran), the Bible etc.
- ◇ Before a proper noun used as a common noun:
Examples: 1. Kalidas is called the Shakespeare of India.
2. Priya is the Lata Mangeshkar of our class.
- ◇ Before a common noun to convey the meaning of an abstract noun:
Examples: 1. The pen is mightier than the sword.
2. The hands that rock the cradle rule the world.
- ◇ To use an adjective as a noun:
Examples: 1. The rich should help the poor.
2. The injured were taken to the hospital.
- ◇ To give superlative force to noun:
Examples: 1. He is the professor. (the best)
2. It was the event of the year. (the most exciting event)
- ◇ Before high titles of honour and rank:
Examples: The great Caesar, Akbar the great, the honourable Minister, the immortal Shakespeare,
- ◇ Before the names of communities and commissions:
Examples: The Sikhs, the English, the Hindus the Jews,
- ◇ Before the names of the states, nations or organisations which consist of a group:
Examples: the UK, the USA, the UAE, the Punjab, the United Nations Organisation
- ◇ Before ordinals:
Examples: The first prize, the second son, the third girl, the tenth of June, the last of us etc.
- ◇ Before unique objects:
Examples: The moon, the sky, the earth, the storm, the tempest

- ◇ Before designations/titles:
Examples: the Principal, the Prime Minister, the Governor etc.
- ◇ Before famous buildings or monuments:
Examples: The Taj Mahal, the Jama Masjid, the Statue of Liberty, the Leaning Tower of Pisa etc.
- ◇ Before directions:
Examples: The east, the west, the north, the south, the left, the right
- ◇ In place of possessive adjectives before the names of parts of the body
Example: He struck the boy on the head. (not his head)
- ◇ Before names of musical instruments:
Examples: the flute, the piano,
- ◇ Before the names of ships:
Examples: the Vikrant, the Titanic
- ◇ Before the names of families:
Examples: the Sharmas, the Tomars, the Guptas
- ◇ Before the names of newspapers, magazines and trains:
Examples: The Tribune, the Punjab Kesari, the Times of India, The Eve's Weekly, The India Today, the Shatabdi Express, the Rajdhani Express etc.
- ◇ Before awards and prizes:
Examples: 1. Tagore won the Nobel Prize for his contribution to literature.
2. Abdul Hamid was awarded with the Param Veer Chakra.
- ◇ Before the names of inventions:
Examples: 1. Do you know who invented the wheel? 2. The telephone is a very useful invention.
- ◇ Used before a proper noun to mention who expired recently or who has lately left the office (post) etc:
Examples: 1. The late Mr. Khanna was a great man. 2. Mr. Sharma, the late Chairman, made a speech.
- ◇ Before the words 'same' and 'whole':
Examples: 1. This is the same book I was looking for. 2. The whole class is making a noise.
- ◇ After the word 'all', 'both' and 'half':
Examples: 1. All the students have completed their work. 2. Half the apples are rotten
3. Both the girls are from Patna.
- ◇ Before a noun when special emphasis is required:
Example: Now is the time to decide.
- ◇ Before the word 'truth':
Example: He always speaks the truth.
- ◇ In certain phrases:
Examples: in the long run, on the other hand, on the way, in the way, all the same, on the contrary, all the more, to the utmost, on the march, in the morning, in the afternoon, in the evening etc.

Omission of Definite Article : 'The'

- ◇ Before a singular noun used in its widest sense:
Examples: 1. Man is mortal. 2. Science tries to discover the laws of nature.
- ◇ Before plural common nouns used in a general sense (not specified or particular):
Examples: 1. Children are fond of sweets. 2. Boys are taller than girls.
- ◇ Before proper nouns:
Example: Delhi is the capital of India.
- ◇ Before abstract nouns:
Examples: 1. Honesty is the best policy. 2. Love is God.

However, if the abstract noun used in a sentence refers to a particular thing, article 'the' is used.

Examples: 1. The love of riches corrupted him.
2. The death of his only son maddened him

- ◇ Before material nouns:

Examples: 1. Gold is a precious metal.
2. This table is made of iron.

However, if the material noun used in a sentence refers to a particular material, article 'the' is used.

Examples: 1. The gold used in this bangle is pure.
2. The wood used in making this chair is of superior quality.

- ◇ Before the names of languages:

Examples: 1. Sankrit is an ancient language.
2. We are learning English.

Important Note: English means English language whereas the English means the people of England.

- ◇ Before places of assembly such as school, hospital, court etc when visited for their primary purpose:

Examples: 1. People go to court to seek justice.
2. We go to hospital to get treatment.

However, if the same places are visited for any other purpose, 'the' is used.

Examples: 1. I visited the court to meet my lawyer.
2. He went to the college to meet his cousin.

- ◇ In certain phrases consisting of a preposition and its object:

Examples: on foot, to school, at home, in hand, at best, from top to bottom, by train, at noon, at night, at daybreak, at worst, in jail, at sight,

- ◇ In certain phrases consisting of a transitive verb followed by its object :

Examples: give ears, catch fire, send word, leave school, lose heart, take offence, set sail etc.

- ◇ Before names of single mountains or single islands :

Examples: Everest, Srilanka, Australia,

- ◇ Before the names of countries, continents, capes, cities, towns, days, month, arts, languages, sciences, diseases etc:

Examples: India, Asia, Mumbai, Ferozepur, Sunday, February, Chinese, Malaria etc.

- ◇ After the phrases, 'kind of', 'sort of', 'type of':

Examples: 1. What kind of man is he? 2. What sort of books do you want?

- ◇ Before common nouns used in pairs:

Examples: 1. Husband and wife lived happily. 2. Girl after girl left the class.

- ◇ Before the names of festivals:

Examples: Deepawali, Christmas, Easter etc.

- ◇ Before the word home:

Examples: 1. My father is at home. 2. He came back home in the evening.

- ◇ Before meal-time, unless it is specified:

Examples: 1. I met her at dinner. 2. The dinner that Mrs. Verma hosted was amazing.

Repetition of the Article

Read the following sentences carefully.

1. I have a black and white cow. (one cow)
2. I have a black and a white cow. (two cows)
3. The poet and novelist is no more. (one person)
4. The poet and the novelist are no more. (two persons)
5. He is a better human being than businessman. (incorrect)
6. He is a better human being than a businessman. (correct)

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with the article 'a', 'an' or 'the'. Put a (X) where the article is not required.

1. cow is.....useful animal.
2.loyalty israre virtue these days.
3. I metold man on the road.man had.....dog with him.
4.cricket is.....most popular game.
5.bananas are sold by.....dozen.
6. All.....were amazed to see.....braveryboy exhibited.
7.Ganga isholy river.
8.Chandigarh isbeautiful city situated at the foot of.....Shivalik Hills.
9.Mahabharata isgreat epic.
10.iron is.....useful metal.
11. Sneha is called.....Aishwarya Roy of our class.
12.humble always get respect.
13. Dhoni was declared.....man of.....match.
14.iron used in this gate is rusted.
15.Hindi is our national language.
16.Geeta is.....holy book of.....Hindus.
17. I am going to.....school.
18.Punjab isstate known for its saints and gurus.
19. My brother has got.....second prize in.....painting competition.
20.world has turned intoglobal village.
21.temple isplace where people worship God.
22. We visited.....Red Fort last year.
23.sun rises in.....east.
24. He caught me by.....arm.
25. My brother is playing on.....harmonium.
26. I went tolibrary to returnbooks.
27. This is.....same watch my uncle gifted me.
28. All.....boys are playing in.....playground.
29. We should always speak.....truth.
30.women are fond of shopping.
31. My father came home at.....night.

32. I haveheadache.
33.late Mrs. Verma was a religious lady.
34.politics is.....dirty game.
35. Once.....liar, always.....liar.
36.more we get.....greedier we become.
37. He isSachin Tendulkar.
38.teacher and.....co-ordinator is on leave today.
39.French Revolution started.....new era.
40.postman goes from.....door to.....door to deliver letters.
41. I bought.....blue and.....red shirt. (one shirt)
42. I boughtblue andred shirt. (two shirts)
43. I am in.....hurry.
44. This is.....news to me.
45. My mother is not at.....home.
46.whole country mourned over Kalam's death.
47. Keep to.....left.
48. I take.....breakfast early.
49. The teacher made him.....monitor.
50.Principal declared a holiday on.....Monday.

Exercise: Correct the following sentences:

1. An European dish is very famous.
2. We saw a elephant in the zoo.
3. The capital of UK is London.
4. Shreya gifted me the watch.
5. He went back a hour ago.
6. Riya went back the home early today.
7. Of the two solutions, the second was better.
8. Camel is called ship of desert.
9. He returned home after the sunset.
10. Shatabdi express runs very fast.
11. Mohan is a NDA officer.
12. I go to office by a car.

Adjectives of Number as Determiners

An adjective of number, when used as a determiner, describes the number of a noun. It answers the question, 'how many'. It is used for countable nouns.

There are two types of adjectives of number.

(i) Definite Numeral Adjectives: Definite numeral adjectives indicate the exact number of a noun.

Example: **Five** girls are playing in the park.

There are two types of definite numeral adjectives.

(a) Cardinals: Cardinals denote the exact number of a noun.

Example: There are **ten** students in this row.

(b) Ordinals: Ordinals denote the order or rank of a noun. Examples: first, second, third, tenth, last, next etc.

Article 'the' or a possessive determiner is used before an ordinal.

Examples: The **third** boy in this row is my friend. 2. Pt. J.L. Nehru was the first Prime Minister of India.

(ii) Indefinite Numeral Adjectives: An indefinite numeral adjectives doesn't indicate the exact number of the noun it refers to.

Examples: 1. **Several** pages of this book are torn. 2. There are **many** monkeys on this tree.

Adjectives of Quantity as Determiners

An adjective of quantity indicates the quantity of a noun. It answers the question, 'how much'. It is used before uncountable nouns.

Examples: **some, any, no, much, little, half, all, whole, sufficient, enough, great, etc.**

1. I ate **some** rice.
2. There is not **much** oil in the bottle.
3. I don't have **any** money.
4. This statement makes **no** sense.
5. They have **sufficient** money to buy a house.
6. I don't have **enough** time to waste on these matters.
7. There was **little** water in the jug.
8. The crow drank **the little** water which was in the jug.

Possessive Adjectives as Possessive Determiners

The words 'my', 'our', 'your', 'his', 'her', 'its' and 'their' are used as possessive adjectives or possessive determiners. They show belonging or possession.

Examples:

1. This is **our** house.
2. They must complete **their** work.
3. It is **his** book.
4. The lion licked **its** paw.

Demonstrative Adjectives as Demonstrative Determiners

The words 'this', 'that', 'these', 'those' and 'such' are called demonstratives as they are used to point out to persons or things they refer to. When these words are used before nouns, they are called demonstrative adjectives or demonstrative determiners.

Look at the use of demonstrative determiners in the following sentences.

1. **This** book is mine. (used for singular thing which is near the speaker)
2. **That** dress is beautiful. (used for singular thing which is at a distance from the speaker)
3. **These** shoes are yours. (used for plural things which are near the speaker)
4. **Those** apples are fresh. (used for plural things which are at a distance from the speaker)
5. I don't appreciate **such** attitude.

Interrogative Adjectives as Interrogative Determiners

The words 'what', 'which' and 'whose', when used before a noun, are called interrogative adjectives or interrogative determiners.

1. **Which** pen is yours?
2. **What** message did he convey to you?
3. **Whose** car is this?

Distributive Adjectives as Determiners

The adjectives that refer to a single person or thing in a group, one at a time, are called distributive adjectives. 'each', 'every', 'either', 'neither' are called distributive adjectives. Distributive adjectives are used as determiners before nouns.

Each and Every

'Each' and 'every' are similar in meaning, but there is a difference between the two. Each is used when speaking of two or more persons or things. 'Every' is used when speaking of more than two persons or things. Each directs attention to every person or thing of a group individually and separately. 'Every' is comprehensive, considering all; it directs attention to the whole group without any exception. 'Each' is used to denote a person or thing out of a known or limited group. 'Every' is used in a wide sense to denote persons or things when the number is unlimited.

Examples:

1. **Each** participant was given a certificate. (considering each individual out of a limited group)
2. **Every** man wants to be rich. (considering all in an unlimited group)

Either and Neither

'Either' has two meanings: (i) One out of two (ii) Each of two

'Neither' means none out of two.

Examples:

1. There are trees on **either** side of the road. (each out of two)
2. **Neither** side of the road has trees. (None out of two)

Correct Use of Some Determiners

Some and Any

'Some' and 'any' are determiners which can be used for both countable and uncountable nouns.

'Some' is used-

✎ In affirmative sentences:

Examples: He bought some honey. I need some pens.

✎ In questions where 'yes' is the expected answer:

Example: Will you give me some money?

✎ In offers and requests:

Example: Would you like some rice?

'Any' is used-

✎ In negative and interrogative sentences:

Examples: I don't need any help. Do you need any help?

✎ Any also means 'practically everyone' or 'no particular one'.

Examples: Any one can do this.

Give me a pen, any pen will do.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with ‘some’ or ‘any’.

1. Is thereletter for me?
2. Yes, there are.....letters for you.
3. There is not.....milk in the bottle.
4. Don’t worry I will give you.....milk.
5. I went to market to buyhoney.
6. Would you lend me money?
7. Give me a pen. pen will do.

Use of Much and Many

Both ‘much’ and ‘many’ mean ‘a lot of’. Whereas ‘much’ is used with uncountable nouns, ‘many’ is used with countable plural nouns and takes a plural verb. The phrase, ‘many a’ takes a singular noun and a singular verb. Usually, ‘much’ is used in negative and interrogative sentences. ‘many’ is used in all types of sentences.

Examples:

1. I have not taken **much** water today, so I am dehydrated.
2. He was not hungry, so he did not eat **much** rice.

In affirmative clauses we sometimes use ‘much’ in more formal styles:

Example: There is **much** concern about drug addiction in the US.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with ‘much’ or ‘many’:

1. Is there..... unemployment in that area?
2. It was pouring with rain but there wasn’t wind.
3. There are.....children in the playground.
4. a boy is reading his lessons.

Each and Every

Each: Each is used to denote everyone out of a known/ small/ limited group. Each is used when the focus is on each unit or individual in a group separately.

Example: Each participant was given a prize.

Every: ‘Every’ is used to denote one out of a large or indefinite group. It conveys a wide or general sense. ‘Every’ is used when the focus is not on each unit or individual in the group, but the group as a whole.

Example: Every child likes sweet.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with ‘each’ or ‘every’.

1.seat in the hall was booked.
2.man wants to be rich.
3.speaker will be given five minutes.
4.citizen should pay the taxes.

Little, a little, the little

Little, a little, the little are used for uncountable nouns as they are quantitative determiners. There is a difference in the use of these three.

Little: 'Little' is used to express a quantity which is very small, or almost **negligible**. 'Little' means almost nothing or hardly any. It is used to convey a negative sense.

A little: 'A little' means small in quantity but **at least some**. It conveys a positive sense.

The little: 'The little' means **small in quantity, but the whole of it**. It is used to consider the whole however little may be the quantity.

Few, a few, the few

Few, a few, the few are used for countable nouns as they are numeral determiners, but there is a difference in the use of these three.

Few: 'Few' is used to express a number which is very small, or almost **negligible**. 'Few' means almost none or hardly any. It is used to convey a negative sense.

A few: 'A few' means small in number but **at least some**. It conveys a positive sense.

The few: 'The few' means **small in number, but all of them**. It is used to consider all however few may be the number.

Exercise: Fill in the blank with 'little', 'a little', 'the little', 'few', 'a few' or 'the few'.

1. I am a complete stranger in this city. I have.....friends.
2. I am new in this city, but I have.....friends.
3. I don't have many friends, butfriends I have are very loyal.
4. I am sorry, I havemoney to help you.
5. I havemoney, but I have to keep it safe for my son's school fee.
6. I will give you.....money I have.
7. There werestudents in the class, so the teacher did not take the class.
8. There were only.....students in the class today.
9.students who were present in the class were not in a mood to study.
10. He is a man ofwords. (hardly speaks)
11.days' rest will help you.
12. He gave the beggarcoins he had.

Use of More

'More' is used with both countable and uncountable nouns. It is the comparative degree of both much and many. It is used with singular uncountable nouns and plural countable nouns.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks:

1. I want somerice.
2. I wantbananas.
3. The child is still hungry. It wantsmilk.
4. We have some guests at home, so we needapples.

Use of Fewer/ Less

‘Fewer’ is the comparative degree of few. It is used to compare the number of two countable nouns. ‘Less’ is the comparative degree of little. It is used to compare the quantity of two uncountable nouns.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with ‘fewer’ or ‘less’:

1. We spenttime in Shimla than Kufri.
2. If you are careful, you will have.....trouble.
3. Some students have left the hostel, so today we needloaves of bread andbutter.

Use of Elder, older, eldest, oldest

‘Elder’ and ‘eldest’ are used only for persons. Elder is never followed by ‘than’. It is followed by ‘to’.

Example: She is elder to me.

‘Elder’ and ‘eldest’ are used only while comparing members of the same family. ‘Older’ and ‘oldest’ are used for both living beings and things.

Exercise: Fill in the blanks with ‘elder’, ‘eldest’, ‘older’ or ‘oldest’

1. Mybrother is a doctor.
2. My friend Seema is.....than I am.
3. The museum is the.....building in the city.
4. My grandfather is the.....member of the family.

Use of Later, latter, latest, last

‘Later’ and ‘latest’ refer to time; ‘latter’ and ‘last’ refer to position.

1. A **later** enquiry into the matter revealed that the owner was murdered.
2. What is the **latest** news?
3. The **latter** chapters are a little boring.
4. The **last** chapter is very interesting.

Use of Farther and Further

‘Farther’ means more distant or advanced; ‘further’ means additional.

Examples:

1. Shimla is **farther** from equator than Rajasthan.
2. After this, he made no **further** remarks.
3. You must present the report without **further** delay.

Use of Nearest and Next

‘Nearest’ denotes distance; ‘next’ denotes position

1. Kasauli is the **nearest** hill station to Chandigarh.
2. My friend's house is **next** to the SBI bank.
3. My aunt lives in the **next** house.

Exercise: Correct the following sentences.

1. He ate few oranges he had.
2. Please give me any honey.
3. He made no farther statement.
4. There is not many water in the bottle.
5. Each man wants to be famous.
6. My wound is healing. It doesn't hurt much more.
7. There is hardly some girl in the ground.
8. I want to have the little milk.....
9. By these time, she had finished her work.
10. I have many problem.
11. We saw a old lady.
12. He is at home in each part of India.
13. The nature is benevolent.
14. Trust the God and you will not fail.
15. We are on wrong track.
16. My uncle lives in the nearest house.
17. Tamilnadu is further from the equator than Madhya Pradesh.
.....
18. Meet my older brother.
19. What is the last information?
20. There are little coins in his pocket.